



## **INSTRUCTIONAL AREA**

### Promotion

## **MARKETING COMMUNICATION SERIES EVENT**

### **PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS**

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21<sup>st</sup> Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

### **21<sup>st</sup> CENTURY SKILLS**

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- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

### **PERFORMANCE INDICATORS**

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1. Explain the nature of marketing plans.
2. Explain the concept of market and market identification.
3. Identify components of a retail image.
4. Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.
5. Describe word-of-mouth channels used to communicate with targeted audiences.

## EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the marketing manager at RUNNERS' HAVEN, a retail chain specializing in running shoes, apparel, and gear for all levels of runners, from beginners to competitive athletes. RUNNERS' HAVEN is known for its personalized fitting service and high-quality, performance-focused products. The store has built a strong following among Millennials and older fitness enthusiasts, but there's a desire to attract more Gen Z customers.

One of RUNNERS' HAVEN's primary competitors is ZAMAZON, a large online retailer that offers a wide range of running shoes, apparel, and gear at significantly lower prices. While ZAMAZON's pricing strategy attracts budget-conscious consumers, particularly within the Gen Z demographic, they lack the personalized customer service that RUNNERS' HAVEN is known for. This gap presents an opportunity for RUNNERS' HAVEN to emphasize our unique selling points, such as our personalized fitting services, expert staff, and community-oriented events. By highlighting the value of these experiences, we can differentiate ourselves from ZAMAZON and appeal to Gen Z consumers who prioritize brand authenticity and connection over mere price.

The CEO of RUNNERS' HAVEN (judge) has tasked you with creating a marketing plan to compete with ZAMAZON and attract more Gen Z consumers, who are known for their focus on health and wellness but also highly value online shopping, brand authenticity, and social media engagement.

Your marketing plan should include: A specific target segment within Gen Z, strategies that leverage Gen Z's preferred shopping habits and platforms, and In-store or online incentives that would appeal to this generation.

You will present your plan to the CEO (judge) in a role-play taking place in the CEO's office. The CEO (judge) will begin by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented and answered questions, the CEO (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What types of community-oriented events do you plan to incorporate into your marketing strategy that would resonate most with Gen Z?
2. How do you intend to convey RUNNERS' HAVEN's brand authenticity in your messaging?

| Did the participant:          |                                                                                         | Novice  | Developing | Proficient | Exemplary | Judged Score |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------|------------|-----------|--------------|
| <b>PERFORMANCE INDICATORS</b> |                                                                                         |         |            |            |           |              |
| 1.                            | Explain the nature of marketing plans?                                                  | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7    | 8-9        | 10        |              |
| 2.                            | Explain the concept of market and market identification?                                | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7    | 8-9        | 10        |              |
| 3.                            | Identify components of a retail image?                                                  | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7    | 8-9        | 10        |              |
| 4.                            | Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior?                | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7    | 8-9        | 10        |              |
| 5.                            | Describe word-of-mouth channels used to communicate with targeted audiences?            | 0-1-2-3 | 4-5-6-7    | 8-9        | 10        |              |
| <b>SOLUTION</b>               |                                                                                         |         |            |            |           |              |
| 6.                            | Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach. | 0-1-2   | 3-4-5      | 6-7        | 8         |              |
| 7.                            | Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.                                   | 0-1-2   | 3-4-5      | 6-7        | 8         |              |
| 8.                            | Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.                                                  | 0-1-2   | 3-4-5      | 6-7        | 8         |              |
| <b>CAREER COMPETENCIES</b>    |                                                                                         |         |            |            |           |              |
| 9.                            | Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.                  | 0-1     | 2-3        | 4-5        | 6         |              |
| 10.                           | Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.                      | 0-1     | 2-3        | 4-5        | 6         |              |
| 11.                           | Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.                                    | 0-1     | 2-3        | 4-5        | 6         |              |
| <b>OVERALL IMPRESSION</b>     |                                                                                         |         |            |            |           |              |
| 12.                           | Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.   | 0-1-2   | 3-4-5      | 6-7        | 8         |              |
| <b>TOTAL SCORE</b>            |                                                                                         |         |            |            |           |              |